

# MASTER SPECIAL POINTS DECODER

*Every Special-Point Category, Cumulative, Tiered A/B/C*

Five Shu - Yuan - Luo - Back-Shu - Front-Mu - Xi-Cleft - He-Sea - Confluent -  
Command - Hui-Meeting



## TIER A

*Dr. Zhang's confirmed final-exam review emphasis -- know cold*

## TIER B

*Quiz-tested (Quiz 1-6) and/or high clinical yield -- know well*

## TIER C

*Classical/reference material -- lower priority per Dr. Zhang's Week 9 statement*

*This is NOT the weekly Study Guide -- organized BY POINT CATEGORY, not by channel.*

## SPECIAL POINT CATEGORY DEFINITIONS

*Read this page FIRST -- every table after assumes you know these terms*

### Five Shu (Transport) Points

A set of 5 points on each of the 12 primary meridians, located distal to the elbows/knees, through which Qi is said to flow like water: Jing-Well (emerges) -> Ying-Spring (flows) -> Shu-Stream (pours) -> Jing-River (travels) -> He-Sea (enters). Each stage has a distinct clinical application (first aid, febrile disease, joint pain, externally-contracted disease, and Fu-organ disorders, respectively).

### Yuan-Source Point

The point where a channel's "Source Qi" (Yuan Qi) is most concentrated and accessible -- effectively the primary tonification/regulation point for that channel's associated organ. On Yin channels it coincides with the Shu-Stream point; on Yang channels it is a separate 6th point.

### Luo-Connecting (Luo) Point

The point where a small branch ("Luo-vessel") splits off from the main channel and runs to its internally-externally paired channel, physically linking the two. Used to treat either channel from one point, and clinically significant for chronic/deficiency patterns of the paired organ.

### Back-Shu (Transport) Point

One of 12 points on the Bladder channel's inner back line, each directly overlying/associated with a specific Zang-Fu organ. Back-Shu points are the most direct route to influence an organ's Qi from the body's posterior surface -- used heavily in both diagnosis (palpation tenderness) and treatment.

## Front-Mu (Alarm) Point

A point on the chest or abdomen, on the front of the body, most closely associated with a specific Zang-Fu organ -- often located near that organ's physical location. Front-Mu points are especially useful for ACUTE organ disorders and, like Back-Shu points, are diagnostically tender on palpation.

## Xi-Cleft (Accumulation) Point

A point where a channel's Qi and Blood pool or "accumulate" more deeply than usual. The go-to point category for ACUTE, often painful presentations of that channel's pathology -- acute pain, acute bleeding, or acute spasm -- distinct from the more chronic focus of He-Sea points.

## He-Sea (Uniting) Point

The point nearest the elbow or knee where a channel's Qi is said to converge/"enter" most fully, like a river reaching the sea. Classically used for disorders of the Six Fu (hollow) organs and for rebellious/reversed Qi (e.g., vomiting, diarrhea).

## Lower He-Sea Point

A special subset of He-Sea points specifically for the 6 Fu organs, located on the leg. Three Fu organs (ST, GB, BL) use their own He-Sea point; the other three (LI, SI, SJ) BORROW a point on a different Foot channel entirely -- a frequently-tested distinction.

## Confluent (Opening) Point

One of 8 points on the 12 primary meridians that each "open" (activate) one of the 8 Extraordinary Vessels. Confluent points are the ONLY way to access an Extraordinary Vessel's function through needling, since the vessels themselves (except GV/CV) have no points of their own.

## Command Point

One of a small classical set of points (the Four Command Points/Si Zong Xue) each said to "command" -- have outsized therapeutic reach over -- an entire body region (abdomen, back, face/mouth, head/nape), regardless of where the specific complaint is located within that region.

## Hui-Meeting (Influential) Point

One of 8 points, each governing a broad tissue/substance category (Qi, Blood, Bone, Marrow, Sinew, Vessels, and the Zang or Fu organs as groups) rather than a single channel or organ -- used when a condition affects that category broadly, cutting across multiple channels.

## Crossing (Meeting) Point

A point where two or more channels physically intersect or run together for a stretch. A crossing point can be needled to influence every channel that passes through it, not just the channel it's numbered under -- explaining why some points (e.g. GV14, SP6) show up in multiple channels' pathology.

FIVE SHU (TRANSPORT) POINTS --

60-POINT MASTER TABLE

A specific group of 5 points on each of the 12 primary meridians, situated distal to the elbows/knees: Jing-Well (“where it emerges”, tips of fingers/toes, first aid/resuscitation), Ying-Spring (“where it flows”, before MCP/MTP, febrile disease), Shu-Stream (“where it pours”, after MCP/MTP, heaviness & joint pain), Jing-River (“where it travels”, forearm/lower leg, externally-contracted disease), He-Sea (“where it enters”, near elbow/knee, disorders of the six Fu).

Split into two narrower tables so neither requires horizontal scrolling on a phone or tablet.

Jing-Well -> Ying-Spring -> Shu-Stream

| Meridian             | Jing-Well      | Ying-Spring   | Shu-Stream   |
|----------------------|----------------|---------------|--------------|
| Lung (LU)            | LU11 Shaoshang | LU10 Yuji     | LU9 Taiyuan  |
| Large Intestine (LI) | LI1 Shangyang  | LI2 Erjian    | LI3 Sanjian  |
| Stomach (ST)         | ST45 Lidui     | ST44 Neiting  | ST43 Xiangu  |
| Spleen (SP)          | SP1 Yinbai     | SP2 Dadu      | SP3 Taibai   |
| Heart (HT)           | HT9 Shaochong  | HT8 Shaofu    | HT7 Shenmen  |
| Small Intestine (SI) | SI1 Shaoze     | SI2 Qianggu   | SI3 Houxi    |
| Bladder (BL)         | BL67 Zhiyin    | BL66 Zutonggu | BL65 Shugu   |
| Kidney (KI)          | KI1 Yongquan   | KI2 Rangu     | KI3 Taixi    |
| Pericardium (PC)     | PC9 Zhongchong | PC8 Laogong   | PC7 Daling   |
| San Jiao (SJ)        | SJ1 Guanchong  | SJ2 Yemen     | SJ3 Zhongzhu |

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| Meridian         | Jing-Well      | Ying-Spring  | Shu-Stream   |
|------------------|----------------|--------------|--------------|
| Gallbladder (GB) | GB44 Zuqiaoyin | GB43 Xiaxi   | GB41 Zulinqi |
| Liver (LR)       | LR1 Dadun      | LR2 Xingjian | LR3 Taichong |

## Jing-River -> He-Sea

| Meridian             | Jing-River    | He-Sea            |
|----------------------|---------------|-------------------|
| Lung (LU)            | LU8 Jingqu    | LU5 Chize         |
| Large Intestine (LI) | LI5 Yangxi    | LI11 Quchi        |
| Stomach (ST)         | ST41 Jiexi    | ST36 Zusanli      |
| Spleen (SP)          | SP5 Shangqiu  | SP9 Yinlingquan   |
| Heart (HT)           | HT4 Lingdao   | HT3 Shaohai       |
| Small Intestine (SI) | SI5 Yanggu    | SI8 Xiaohai       |
| Bladder (BL)         | BL60 Kunlun   | BL40 Weizhong     |
| Kidney (KI)          | KI7 Fuliu     | KI10 Yingu        |
| Pericardium (PC)     | PC5 Jianshi   | PC3 Quze          |
| San Jiao (SJ)        | SJ6 Zhigou    | SJ10 Tianjing     |
| Gallbladder (GB)     | GB38 Yangfu   | GB34 Yanglingquan |
| Liver (LR)           | LR4 Zhongfeng | LR8 Ququan        |

Yin meridians have NO separate Yuan-Source point -- the Shu-Stream point IS the Yuan point (e.g. Taiyuan LU9 is both Shu-Stream and Yuan for Lung; Taixi KI3 for Kidney). Yang meridians have a 6th, separate Yuan-Source point beyond the 5 Shu points (e.g. Chongyang ST42, Hegu LI4).

YUAN-SOURCE POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

|    |                                       |    |                                                |
|----|---------------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------|
| LU | LU9 Taiyuan                           | BL | BL64 Jinggu                                    |
| LI | LI4 Hegu --<br>FORBIDDEN in pregnancy | KI | KI3 Taixi (also<br>Shu-Stream -- dual<br>role) |
| ST | ST42 Chongyang                        | PC | PC7 Daling                                     |
| SP | SP3 Taibai                            | SJ | SJ4 Yangchi                                    |
| HT | HT7 Shenmen                           | GB | GB40 Qiuxu                                     |
| SI | SI4 Wangu                             | LR | LR3 Taichong                                   |

On YIN channels, the Yuan-Source point IS the Shu-Stream point (dual role, same point). On YANG channels, Yuan-Source is a separate 6th point beyond the 5 Shu points.

LUO-CONNECTING POINTS -- ALL 15

| Luo Point     | Connection | Note                                    |
|---------------|------------|-----------------------------------------|
| LU7 Lieque    | LU -> LI   | also opens Ren Mai (Week 7)             |
| LI6 Pianli    | LI -> LU   | closest pairing around the wrist to LU7 |
| ST40 Fenglong | ST -> SP   | #1 phlegm point in TCM                  |
| SP4 Gongsun   | SP -> ST   | also opens Chong Mai                    |
| HT5 Tongli    | HT -> SI   | 1 cun above wrist crease                |
| SI7 Zhizheng  | SI -> HT   | 5 cun above wrist                       |

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| Luo Point         | Connection                                  | Note                                                    |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| BL58<br>Feiyang   | BL -> KI                                    | 7 cun above external malleolus                          |
| KI4<br>Dazhong    | KI -> BL                                    | posterior to internal malleolus                         |
| PC6<br>Neiguan    | PC -> SJ                                    | also opens Yin Wei Mai                                  |
| SJ5<br>Waiguan    | SJ -> PC                                    | also opens Yang Wei Mai                                 |
| GB37<br>Guangming | GB -> LR                                    | 5 cun above external malleolus                          |
| LR5 Ligou         | LR -> GB                                    | 5 cun above internal malleolus                          |
| CV15 Jiuwei       | Ren Mai<br>collateral                       | spreads over the FRONT midline/abdomen                  |
| GV1<br>Changqiang | Du Mai<br>collateral                        | spreads over the BACK midline                           |
| SP21 Dabao        | Great<br>(Major)<br>Collateral<br>of Spleen | covers the LATERAL chest -- why there are 15,<br>not 12 |

Connecting (Luo) points of HAND meridians cluster around the WRIST. Connecting points of FOOT meridians cluster around the ANKLE/MALLEOLUS. CV/GV/SP-Great-Luo are the exceptions, covering front midline, back midline, and lateral chest respectively.



## BACK-SHU POINTS -- ORGAN TRANSPORT SERIES (BL13-BL28)

| Point             | Organ Treated   |
|-------------------|-----------------|
| BL13 Feishu       | Lung            |
| BL14 Jueyinshu    | Pericardium     |
| BL15 Xinshu       | Heart           |
| BL18 Ganshu       | Liver           |
| BL19 Danshu       | Gallbladder     |
| BL20 Pishu        | Spleen          |
| BL21 Weishu       | Stomach         |
| BL22 Sanjiaoshu   | San Jiao        |
| BL23 Shenshu      | Kidney          |
| BL25 Dachangshu   | Large Intestine |
| BL27 Xiaochangshu | Small Intestine |
| BL28 Pangguangshu | Bladder         |

All 12 Back-Shu points sit on the Bladder channel's inner line, 1.5 cun lateral to the spine -- roughly in organ order top-to-bottom. BL20 (Spleen) and BL21 (Stomach) sit directly adjacent and are a classic confusable pair.

## FRONT-MU POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

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|    |                               |    |                  |
|----|-------------------------------|----|------------------|
| LU | LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual)  | BL | CV3 Zhongji      |
| LI | ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel)  | KI | GB25 Jingmen     |
| ST | CV12 Zhongwan                 | PC | CV17 Danzhong    |
| SP | LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel) | SJ | CV5 Shimen       |
| HT | CV14 Jueque                   | GB | GB24 Riyue (own) |
| SI | CV4 Guanyuan                  | LR | LR14 Qimen (own) |

Front-Mu points are scattered across several channels (CV, ST, LR, GB) rather than clustered on one channel like Back-Shu -- the classic Front-Mu exam trap is assuming a point sits on its own channel (e.g. ST25 is Front-Mu of LARGE INTESTINE, not Stomach).

## XI-CLEFT POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

|    |               |    |              |
|----|---------------|----|--------------|
| LU | LU6 Kongzui   | BL | BL63 Jinmen  |
| LI | LI7 Wenliu    | KI | KI5 Shuiquan |
| ST | ST34 Liangqiu | PC | PC4 Ximen    |
| SP | SP8 Diji      | SJ | SJ7 Huizong  |
| HT | HT6 Yinxi     | GB | GB36 Waiqiu  |
| SI | SI6 Yanglao   | LR | LR6 Zhongdu  |

Xi-Cleft points are the go-to for ACUTE presentations of that channel's pathology (acute pain, acute bleeding, acute spasm) -- contrast with He-Sea points, used more for chronic/Fu-organ disorders.

## HE-SEA POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

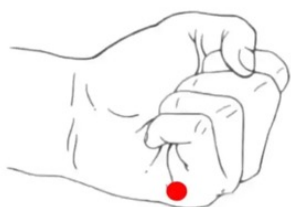
|    |                 |    |                                                   |
|----|-----------------|----|---------------------------------------------------|
| LU | LU5 Chize       | BL | BL40 Weizhong<br>(Command, back)                  |
| LI | LI11 Quchi      | KI | KI10 Yingu                                        |
| ST | ST36 Zusanli    | PC | PC3 Quze                                          |
| SP | SP9 Yinlingquan | SJ | SJ10 Tianjing                                     |
| HT | HT3 Shaohai     | GB | GB34 Yanglingquan<br>(also Hui-Meeting<br>Sinews) |
| SI | SI8 Xiaohai     | LR | LR8 Ququan                                        |

## LOWER HE-SEA POINTS -- THE 6 FU ORGANS

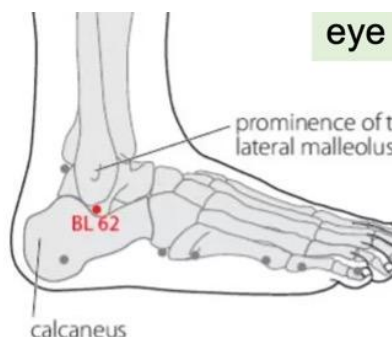
| Point                | Fu Organ          | Use                                                       |
|----------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| ST37<br>Shangjuxu    | Large Intestine   | LI bowel disorders (diarrhea, appendicitis-type pain)     |
| ST39 Xiajuxu         | Small Intestine   | SI bowel disorders, lower abdominal pain                  |
| BL39 Weiyang         | San Jiao          | water metabolism, edema, lower back/leg pain              |
| ST36 Zusanli         | Stomach (own)     | master tonic, digestion, immunity                         |
| GB34<br>Yanglingquan | Gallbladder (own) | also Hui-Meeting of Sinews -- tendons, hypochondriac pain |
| BL40<br>Weizhong     | Bladder (own)     | also Command Point of the back                            |

The 6 Fu (hollow) organs each have a Lower He-Sea point on the leg. ST, GB, and BL simply use their own He-Sea point (already Fu channels). LI, SI, and SJ -- despite being Hand channels -- BORROW a Lower He-Sea point on a FOOT channel (ST or BL) instead of using a point on their own pathway. This is a classic exam trap: LI's and SI's Lower He-Sea points are NOT on the LI or SI channel at all.

## EIGHT CONFLUENT POINTS -- OPEN THE 8 EXTRAORDINARY VESSELS



Spine pain, fever



SI3 Houxi + BL62 Shenmai

Opens: Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai

Use: posterior body, spine, neck, febrile disease

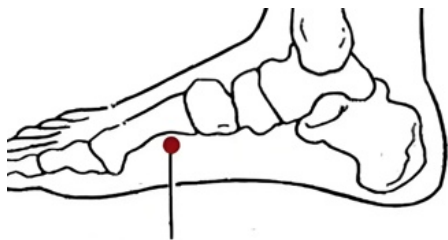


LU7 Lieque + KI6 Zhaohai

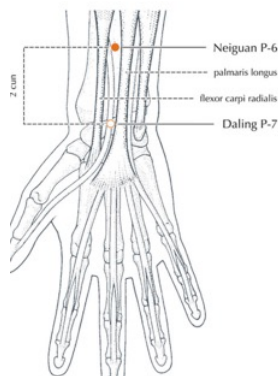
Opens: Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai

Use: throat, chest, lung, insomnia





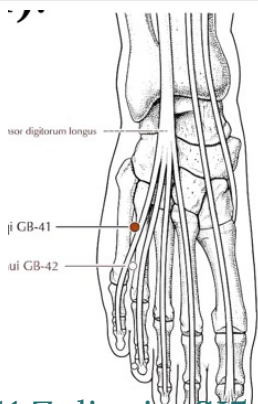
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### SP4 Gongsun + PC6 Neiguan

Opens: Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai

Use: chest, heart, stomach -- MOST-used pairing in clinic



### GB41 Zulinqi + SJ5 Waiguan

Opens: Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai

Use: lateral body, hypochondriac pain, exterior disorders



## FOUR COMMAND POINTS (SI ZONG XUE)

| Point         | Governs Region | Note                                                   |
|---------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| ST36 Zusanli  | Abdomen        | the #1 tonic point in TCM; He-Sea + Lower He-Sea of ST |
| BL40 Weizhong | Back           | He-Sea of BL; "aspirin of acupuncture"                 |
| LU7 Lieque    | Head / Nape    | Luo of LU; also Confluent point opening Ren Mai        |
| LI4 Hegu      | Face / Mouth   | Yuan-Source of LI; FORBIDDEN in pregnancy              |

The Four Command Points (Si Zong Xue) -- a classical mnemonic distinct from, but often confused with, the 8 Confluent Points. "Command" points treat a whole body REGION; Confluent points open an Extraordinary Vessel. Some points (LU7, LI4) do double duty as both a Command point AND part of another special category -- always check whether a question is asking about regional command or vessel confluence.

## EIGHT HUI-MEETING (INFLUENTIAL) POINTS

| Point         | Governs             | Use                                        |
|---------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| CV12 Zhongwan | Fu (Hollow) Organs  | digestive disorders, all six Fu organs     |
| LR13 Zhangmen | Zang (Solid) Organs | organ-level disharmony, hypochondriac pain |

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| Point                        | Governs            | Use                                                         |
|------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| CV17<br>Danzhong             | Qi                 | chest Qi stagnation, breathing, lactation                   |
| BL17 Geshu                   | Blood              | all blood disorders -- bleeding, stasis, deficiency         |
| BL11 Dazhu                   | Bone               | bone disorders, also a classic exterior-releasing point     |
| GB39<br>Xuanzhong<br>(Juegu) | Marrow             | marrow, brain, spinal cord, also relates to bone marrow     |
| GB34<br>Yanglingquan         | Sinew<br>(Tendon)  | tendons/ligaments, also He-Sea of GB and Lower He-Sea of GB |
| LU9 Taiyuan                  | Vessels<br>(Pulse) | all pulse/vessel disorders, also Yuan-Source of LU          |

The 8 Hui-Meeting (Influential) Points are classical CAM/MOA reference material -- each governs a tissue/substance category rather than a single channel. Not explicitly confirmed as part of Dr. Zhang's live review, but standard course-textbook material worth recognizing (Tier C).



## CROSSING (MEETING) POINTS -- BY CHANNEL

| Channel | Count | Note                                                                                      |
|---------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ST      | 11    | the MOST of any single primary channel -- LI20, BL1, GB3/4/6, SP1, GV24, GV26, CV12/13/24 |
| BL      | 14    | shared specifically with GV and Gallbladder, concentrated around the head                 |
| GB      | 12    | across 6 meridians (SJ, LR, PC, SI, ST, GV) -- confirmed against the 2026 slide deck      |
| SJ      | 10+   | shares crossing points with GB around head/ear/shoulder, plus GV14, SI12                  |
| SP      | 6     | abdomen/chest region -- CV3, CV4, CV10, GB24, LR14, LU1                                   |
| LR      | 6     | shared with CV (2) and SP (1) around the genital/abdomen region                           |
| SI / LI | few   | crosses GV14 and the cheek/eye/shoulder region                                            |
| HT / PC | 0     | the ONLY 2 primary channels with ZERO named crossing points -- classic paired trap        |

Per Dr. Zhang's Week 9 review, deep crossing-point memorization is lower priority than the pathway and special-point material above -- know the notable counts (ST=11 most, HT/PC=0) rather than every individual crossing point.

## CROSS-REFERENCE INDEX -- ONE RECORD PER CHANNEL

*Every category, in narrow record format -- no horizontal scrolling*

### LU -- Lung

Yuan: LU9 Taiyuan · Luo: LU7 Lieque · Xi-Cleft: LU6 Kongzui · He-Sea: LU5 Chize · Back-Shu: BL13 Feishu · Front-Mu: LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual) · Confluent/Cmd: LU7 -- opens Ren Mai (paired w/ KI6)

### LI -- Large Intestine

Yuan: LI4 Hegu -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy · Luo: LI6 Pianli · Xi-Cleft: LI7 Wenliu · He-Sea: LI11 Quchi · Back-Shu: BL25 Dachangshu · Front-Mu: ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel) · Confluent/Cmd: LI4 -- face/mouth

### ST -- Stomach

Yuan: ST42 Chongyang · Luo: ST40 Fenglong · Xi-Cleft: ST34 Liangqiu · He-Sea: ST36 Zusanli · Back-Shu: BL21 Weishu · Front-Mu: CV12 Zhongwan · Confluent/Cmd: ST36 -- abdomen; Lower He-Sea ST37 (LI) / ST39 (SI)

### SP -- Spleen

Yuan: SP3 Taibai · Luo: SP4 Gongsun · Xi-Cleft: SP8 Diji · He-Sea: SP9 Yinlingquan · Back-Shu: BL20 Pishu · Front-Mu: LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel) · Confluent/Cmd: SP4 -- opens Chong Mai (paired w/ PC6)

### HT -- Heart

Yuan: HT7 Shenmen · Luo: HT5 Tongli · Xi-Cleft: HT6 Yinxi · He-Sea: HT3 Shaohai · Back-Shu: BL15 Xinshu · Front-Mu: CV14 Juque · Confluent/Cmd: none

### SI -- Small Intestine

Yuan: SI4 Wangu · Luo: SI7 Zhizheng · Xi-Cleft: SI6 Yanglao · He-Sea: SI8 Xiaohai · Back-Shu: BL27 Xiaochangshu · Front-Mu: CV4 Guanyuan · Confluent/Cmd: SI3 Houxi -- opens Du Mai (paired w/ BL62)

## BL -- Bladder

Yuan: BL64 Jinggu · Luo: BL58 Feiyang · Xi-Cleft: BL63 Jinmen · He-Sea: BL40 Weizhong (Command, back) · Back-Shu: BL28 Pangguangshu (own) · Front-Mu: CV3 Zhongji · Confluent/Cmd: BL62 Shenmai -- opens Yang Qiao Mai (paired w/ SI3)

## KI -- Kidney

Yuan: KI3 Taixi (also Shu-Stream -- dual role) · Luo: KI4 Dazhong · Xi-Cleft: KI5 Shuiquan · He-Sea: KI10 Yingu · Back-Shu: BL23 Shenshu · Front-Mu: GB25 Jingmen · Confluent/Cmd: KI6 Zhaohai -- opens Yin Qiao Mai (paired w/ LU7)

## PC -- Pericardium

Yuan: PC7 Daling · Luo: PC6 Neiguan · Xi-Cleft: PC4 Ximen · He-Sea: PC3 Quze · Back-Shu: BL14 Jueyinshu · Front-Mu: CV17 Danzhong · Confluent/Cmd: PC6 -- opens Yin Wei Mai (paired w/ SP4) -- most-used confluent pairing in clinic

## SJ -- San Jiao / Triple Energizer

Yuan: SJ4 Yangchi · Luo: SJ5 Waiguan · Xi-Cleft: SJ7 Huizong · He-Sea: SJ10 Tianjing · Back-Shu: BL22 Sanjiaoshu · Front-Mu: CV5 Shimen · Confluent/Cmd: SJ5 -- opens Yang Wei Mai (paired w/ GB41)

## GB -- Gallbladder

Yuan: GB40 Qiuxu · Luo: GB37 Guangming · Xi-Cleft: GB36 Waiqiu · He-Sea: GB34 Yanglingquan (also Hui-Meeting Sinews) · Back-Shu: BL19 Danshu · Front-Mu: GB24 Riyue (own) · Confluent/Cmd: GB41 Zulinqi -- opens Dai Mai (paired w/ SJ5)

## LR -- Liver

Yuan: LR3 Taichong · Luo: LR5 Ligou · Xi-Cleft: LR6 Zhongdu · He-Sea: LR8 Ququan · Back-Shu: BL18 Ganshu · Front-Mu: LR14 Qimen (own) · Confluent/Cmd: none directly (LR13 is the SP Front-Mu; LR14 is LR's own Front-Mu)